Locality and Extraction in Mandar

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A longstanding question in syntactic theory: what are the types of movement operations made available by the faculty of language, and what gives rise to the differences between them?

The Classical Answer: The syntax distinguishes between two different types of displacement:

1. A-movement, which is strictly local, interacts with Case/Agreement, and targets only DPs,
2. ...and Ā-movement, which avoids these restrictions and obeys looser constraints on locality.

(1) A-Movement: *Mary* seems [___ to have left].
(2) Ā-Movement: *Who* ['d you see ___]?

- **Mystery one**: can these differences be linked to the positions that they target?
  - A-positions: potential thematic positions (argument positions) (Chomsky 1981)
  - Ā-positions: non-thematic positions (adjunct positions) (Chomsky 1989)

A separate question lies in a restriction on Ā-extraction: the Ergative Extraction Constraint

- Ergative-Absolutive alignment: a system of Case/Agreement that's different from English, where intransitive subjects behave like transitive objects instead of transitive subjects.

(3) *Morphological Ergativity*:
  a. *She*$_{\text{ABS}}$ ran.
  b. *Her*$_{\text{ERG}}$ saw she$_{\text{ABS}}$.

- A subset of ergative systems show an apparent restriction in the Ā-domain:
  – You can extract the intransitive subject and transitive object; not the transitive subject.

(4) *The Ergative Extraction Constraint*:
  a. *Who* [left ___$_{\text{ABS}}$]?
  b. *Who* ['d you see ___$_{\text{ABS}}$]?
  c. ✗*Who* [___$_{\text{ERG}}$ saw you]?

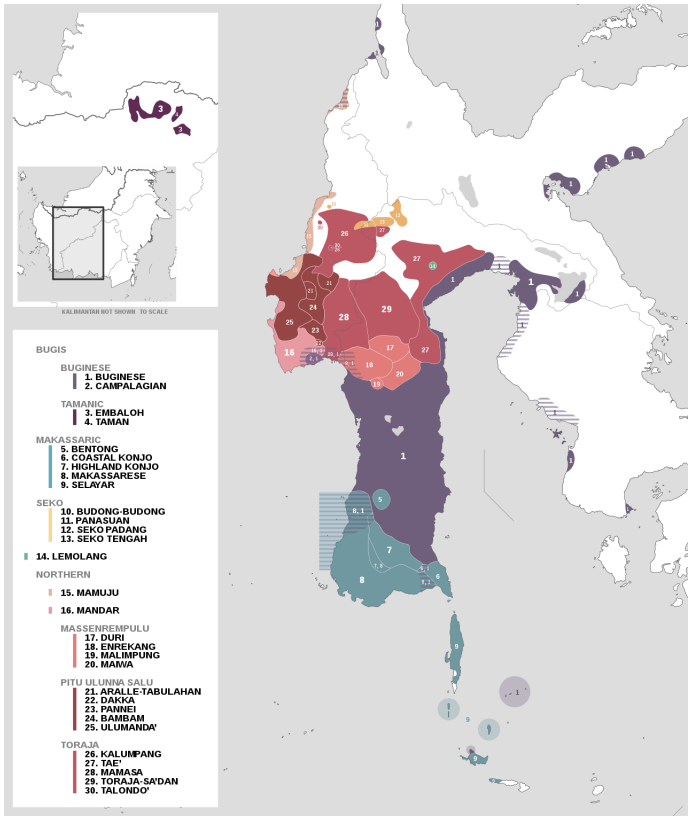
- **Mystery Two**: if Ā-extraction is flexible, why should such a constraint exist?

The goal of this talk: to investigate these matters in Mandar, a language of Indonesia.

1. This language shows the ergative extraction constraint.
2. This reflects a deeper pattern: apparent Ā-operations shows A-style locality.
3. This restriction is linked to the position they target: it's lower than normal Ā-movement.
4. This leads us to architectural questions on the nature of movement and clause-building.

1.0: Mandar

Mandar is a language that's spoken by about 400,000 people on the island of Sulawesi.



The language has the profile of an Austronesian language from this area: (cf. Tagalog)

- Verb-initial word order
- Ergative-absolutive agreement
- Verbal alternations between transitive and antipassive.

The shape of a Mandar clause:

(5) **Mar-rokko i** battang, tapi **na-larang i** dottor.
ANTIP-smoke 3ABS cigarette but 3ERG-forbid 3ABS doctor
"He$_{ABS}$ smokes cigarettes, but the doctor$_{ERG}$ forbids it$_{ABS}$." Sikki et al. 1987; 1192

The data in this talk will come from three sources:

1. Fieldwork in Sulawesi 2019, 2022…
2. Ongoing work with Jupri Talib, Anchu Mansur, and Nabila Haruna 2018-
3. Prior descriptive literature; compiled into a searchable online corpus (www.kratylos.org)

1.1: The Extraction Constraint

Our starting point is a restriction on WH-movement: the Ergative Extraction Constraint.

- In WH-questions, it is possible to extract the **absolutive subject** and the **absolutive object**:

(6) a. **Innai** missung ____$_{ABS}$?
who left
'Who$_{ABS}$ left?'

b. **Innai** mu-ita ____$_{ABS}$?
who 2ERG-see
'Who$_{ABS}$ did you$_{ERG}$ see?'

- But it's not possible to extract the ergative argument.

(7) *__Innai__ na-ita o ____$_{ERG}$?
who 3ERG-see 2ABS
BAD: 'Who$_{ERG}$ saw you$_{ABS}$?'

- The only way to extract the external argument: use a construction where it's absolutive.

(8) **Innai** ma'-ita ____$_{ABS}$ o?
who AGENT.FOCUS-see 2ACC
'Who$_{ABS}$ saw you$_{ACC}$?'

This is part of a broader constraint: **WH-movement can only target the absolutive argument**.

- In antipassive clauses, you can extract the absolutive subject, but not the oblique object.

(9) *__Apa__ mas-saka iAli ____$_{OBL}$?
what ANTIP-catch NAME
BAD: 'What$_{OBL}$'s Ali$_{ABS}$ catching?'

- The same constraint rules out the extraction of many other things.
  - No direct-questioning an argument PP. (**Into what did it fall?*)
  - No direct-questioning a non-DP adjunct. (**where did they go?*)

Summary: there is an "Absolutives-Only Extraction Constraint."

- This is familiar from the literature on Western Austronesia, where similar constraints on argument extraction are widespread (Keenan 1976, Kroeger 1993, Paul 1998, Chen 2017).
- Similar constraints exist in: Inuit (Bittner 1987), West Circassian (Ershova 2019), Kwakwala (Anderson 1984), Salishan (Davis et al. 1993), Tsimshianic (Davis & Brown 2011, Brown 2016), Kanamarí (Katukinan; Queixalos 2010), and parts of Mayan (Larsen & Norman 1979).

N.b.: in Mandar, this holds of relativization and focus-fronting too. We'll focus on WH-questions.

1.2: The Nature of the Restriction

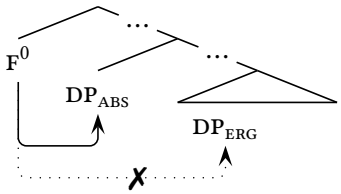
First Challenge: how can we understand the Absolutives-Only Extraction Constraint?

Two lines of thought predominate:

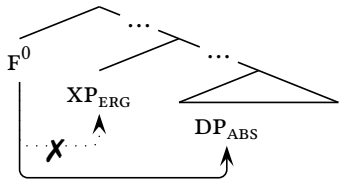
- **Case-Based Accounts** of the constraint:
  - Background: movement is triggered by higher heads (Altruism; Lasnik 1996)
  - These heads only want things with Absolutive Case (Discrimination; Deal 2016)
  - …or they avoid arguments with Ergative Case (Ergative-as-PP: Polinsky 2012)
- **Locality-Based Accounts** of the constraint:
  - The absolutive argument raises above the ergative argument, (Campana 1992)
  - usually due to the way that absolutive Case is assigned, (Levin & Massam 1985)
  - …and this sets up a configuration where only the absolutive argument can extract.

Initial Goal: to build toward a Locality-Based Analysis of Mandar. Brodkin 2022

(10) *The Locality Analysis*



(11) *Rejected: The Case Alternative*



First argument: the source of Absolutive Case sits above the source of Ergative Case.

- The heuristic: the structural positions of absolutive and ergative agreement.

1. Absolutive agreement appears in the middle field, but ergative agreement is verb-adjacent.

   (12) Ndang **i** mala **u**-pau.
   NEG 3ABS can 1ERG-say
   'I can't say it.' Friberg & Jerniati 2000

2. Absolutive agreement, but not ergative agreement, interacts with functional heads that sit high in the clause: ASP^0 (they form portmanteaux) and C^0 (it varies with clause type).

   (13) a. Massau **mi**, jari malai **ma'**.
   recover PFV.3ABS so return PFV.1ABS
   'He recovered, so I came home.' Friberg & Jerniati 2000

   b. Bulang, indoia' mai, anna'-**u** mala ma'-issangi alaweu.
   moon shine on me, that-1ABS.SUBJUNCTIVE might ANTIP-know self
   'Moon, shine on me, that I might know myself.' (Bulang, by Sulkep Liaco')

1.3: High Absolutive Syntax

Second Argument: the absolutive argument always moves above the ergative.

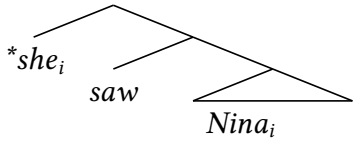
1. The absolutive argument can appear in the middle field, but the ergative argument cannot.

   (14) Rua i **iAli** na-pelambi' iMina.
   Have 3ABS NAME 3ERG-visit NAME
   'Mina$_{\text{ERG}}$ has visited Ali$_{\text{ABS}}$.

2. The absolutive argument c-commands all of the other arguments in the clause.

   - Condition C: names cannot be c-commanded by coindexed pronouns.

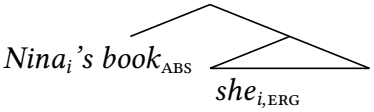
     (15) *English: Condition C*

   - The distribution of pronouns and names shows that the absolutive is high in Mandar:

     (16) Na-na-waca i manini [$_{\text{ABS}}$ buku na-alli iNina dionging].
     will-3ERG-read 3ABS later book 3ERG-buy NAME yesterday
     'She$_i$'ll read the book that Nina$_i$ bought yesterday.'

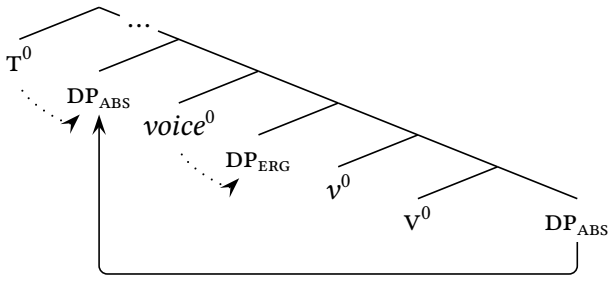
     (17) *Mandar: Condition C*

Drawing these two strands together, we arrive at a High-Absolutive analysis:

- Absolutive Case is assigned by T^0; Ergative Case is assigned by *voice*^{0}.
- The absolutive argument moves above the ergative argument in order to interact with T^0.
- The result: the absolutive argument always moves into the highest position in the clause.

(18) *High-Absolutive Syntax*

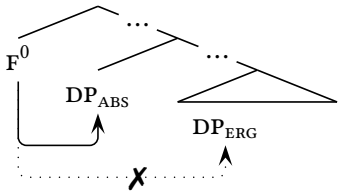


2.0: The Locality Constraint

From this perspective, we can reinterpret the Absolutives-Only Extraction Constraint:

- The absolutive argument is always the highest argument in the clause.
- The head that triggers WH-movement can only attract the closest argument.
- The result: there's no WH-movement of anything except the absolutive argument.

(19) *The Locality Constraint*



Second Challenge: why should WH-movement be subject to such a constraint?

- The classical theory: WH-movement belongs to a class of **"Ā"-movements** that:
  - Bypass most intervening arguments (*What* did you send Mary ___?)
  - Tolerate pied-piping of prepositions (*To whom* did you send the letter ___?)
  - Can escape finite clauses. (*Who* did you visit ___?)
- These operations ostensibly contrast with a class of **"A"-movements**, which:
  - Cannot bypass intervening arguments (**The letter* was sent Mary ___.)
  - Prohibit pied-piping of prepositions (**On the leaf* was stepped ___.)
  - Cannot escape finite clauses. (**Mary* seemed ___ was ok.)

From this standpoint, we can reframe the initial puzzle in a different way:

Could Mandar WH-movement have the properties of A-movement?

Some Guiding Desiderata:

- EXPLANATION: the analysis should derive its results from architectural principles of syntax, not just restate the problem in the lexicon (*cf.* the Borer-Chomsky Conjecture).
- EXTENSION: the analysis should offer a plausible perspective on patterns beyond Mandar (as many High Absolutive languages show a similar constraint; Bittner 1987; Brown 2016…).
- FLEXIBILITY: …and it should provide enough flexibility to account for known exceptions (Pizarro-Guevara 2020, Erlewine & Lim 2022) while still maintaining a restrictive character.

2.1: The Raising Connection

To deconstruct Mandar WH-movement, we'll look at:

- Targets: can it apply to non-DPs? **On a leaf was stepped ___.*
- Finiteness: can it proceed from finite clauses? **Mary seemed ___ was brilliant.*
- Symmetry: does it look like real cases of Raising in the language?

Targets: Mandar WH-movement can only target DPs.

- To form locative questions, you can't extract a PP.

(20) a. Bemme i **tama iting gelas**.
fall 3ABS into this glass.
'It fell into this glass.'

b. ***Tama apa** bemme (i) ____OBL?
into what fall 3ABS
BAD: "Into what did it fall?"

- The strategy: strand the P in a pseudopassive, then extract the DP.

(21) **Apa** na-bemme-i **tama** ____ABS?
what 3ERG-fall-APPL into
'What$_{ABS}$ was fallen into?'

Finiteness: Mandar WH-movement can only proceed out of non-finite clauses.

- The diagnostic: no absolutive agreement.

(22) **Inna** na-mu-pile (**i*)?
which will-2ERG-choose 3ABS
'Which will you pick?'

Symmetry: the same restrictions hold over Raising to Subject.

- Evaluative predicates (hard, easy…) allow for Raising to the absolutive position.
- This process can only target the highest argument of the immediately lower clause.

(23) a. Maparri' i bau [u-ande ____ABS].
tough 3ABS fish 1ERG-eat
'Fish is tough for me$_{ERG}$ to eat ____ABS.'

b. *Maparri a' yau [u-ande ____ERG bau].
tough 1ABS 1SG 1ERG-eat fish
BAD: "I'm tough ____ERG to eat fish$_{ABS}$.'

- And naturally, it requires the lower clause to be non-finite.

2.2: Further Evidence

All of this suggests that Mandar WH-movement has the profile of Raising to Subject:

This result leads us to two further predictions about long-distance WH-movement:

- Finiteness: it should require every clause along its path to be non-finite.
- Strict locality: it should pass through the subject position of every clause on its way.

(24) *Everyone seems [___ to be likely [___ to come to Santa Cruz]].*

Finiteness: every clause along the path of WH-movement must be non-finite.

(25) **Inna** mu-sanga (**i*) ___ [na-u-pile (**i*) ___]] ?
which 2ERG-think 3ABS will-1ERG-pick 3ABS
'Which one do you think I'll pick?'

Strict locality: WH-words pass through the absolutive position of every clause on their way.

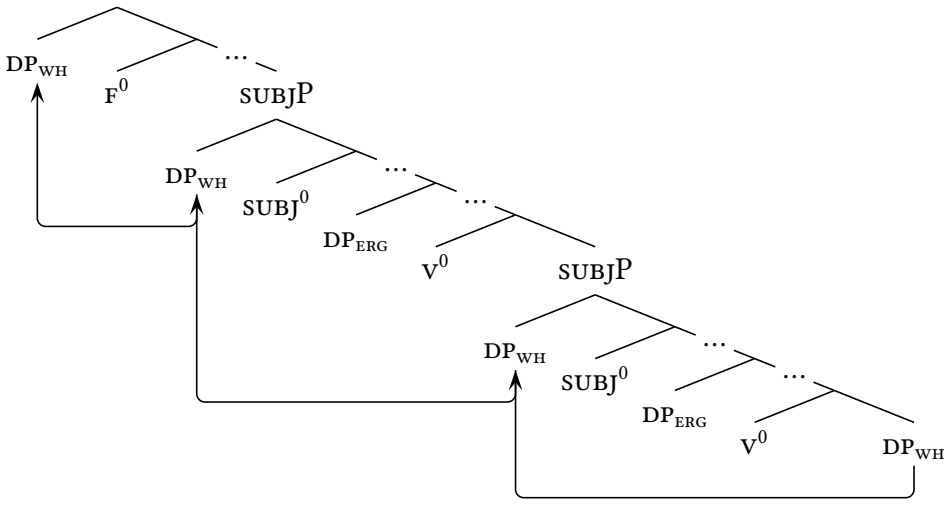
- Clausal embedding verbs are usually antipassive (OBJECT $\neq$ ABS), but:
- When WH-words are extracted across them, they take the kind of morphology that would appear if objects or applied arguments raised to the absolutive position.

(26) a. **Mah**-hara a' mua' **ma'**-ua i iAli mua' **mang**-uma i iMina.
ANTIP-hope 1ABS that ANTIP-say 3ABS NAME that ANTIP-plant 3ABS NAME
'I hope that Ali said that Mina was planting.'

b. Apa **mu-po**-hara ___ABS **na**-ua-**ngan** iAli ___ABS **na**-uma ___ABS?
what 2ERG-APPL-hope 3ERG-say-APPL NAME 3ERG-plant
'What do you hope ___ Ali said ___ Mina was planting?

Interim Conclusion: WH-movement has the properties of Raising.

(27) *Long-Distance WH-Movement*



3.0: Why is Mandar WH-movement like Raising?

With this result secure, we can understand puzzle one in a slightly different way:

Why does WH-movement have the properties of Raising in Mandar?

N.b.: we're dealing with a pattern that's larger than Mandar.

- The symmetry holds in Western Austronesian: Tagalog (Kroeger 1993), Selayarese (Finer 1997), Indonesian (Cole & Hermon 2005), Malagasy (Paul 1998), Formosan (Chen 2017),
- Plus: Kwakwala (Anderson 1984), Gitxsan (Brown 2016), Thompson River Salish (Kroeber 1997), Ktunaxa (McClay & Birdstone 2015), Dinka Bor (Van Urk 2015), and from the right perspective, K'iche' and Kaqchikel (and possibly related languages; Mendes & Ranero 2021).

The literature on individual cases of this pattern has responded by suggesting:

- that WH-movement is A-movement — Anderson 1984
- that WH-movement is a subtype of Ā-movement — Finer 1997
- that WH-movement is a mixture of A- and Ā-movement — Van Urk 2015

The real question: "Why do movement operations have the properties that they do?"

- The goal of the Minimalist Program: to avoid enshrining these differences as primitives.
- The classical framework of A and Ā is beset with independent challenges.
  - Tough Movement is "unexplained and in principle unexplainable" (Holmberg 2000)
  - There are issues with many putative correlates of the split (e.g., Reconstruction)

The result: there's an emerging consensus that we need to to rethink the A-Ā divide.

- One body of work attempts to reformulate the divide in various different ways (Chomsky 2008; Obata & Epstein 2011; Van Urk 2015; Fong 2019, Safir 2019)
- Another seeks to pin down the correlates of the split in a more nuanced way (Gong 2022).

My proposal: there is no primitive split between A- and Ā-movement.

- Both proceed through the same syntactic operation (MOVE; formally AGREE + MERGE).
- Both are triggered by the same types of syntactic features (Generalized EPP-features).
- The locality profile of movement is linked to the height of its landing site.
  - Movement that targets low positions, like SPEC,TP, shows strict A-style locality.
  - Movement that targets high positions, like SPEC,CP, shows the profile of Ā-movement.
- There is no need to posit mixed A-Ā movements or positions (Mahajan 1990).
  - The Ergative Extraction Constraint follows from general constraints on movement.
  - It tracks a broad cross-linguistic pattern: low steps of Ā-movement obey A-locality.

3.1: Clauses that launch Wh-Movement are Smaller

Empirical Foundation: the clauses that launch WH-movement in Mandar are reduced.

1. They must be non-finite.

   (28) [$_{??}$ Innai ma'bottor (*i)]?
   who gamble AGR
   'Who's gambling?'

2. They cannot contain an overt complementizer.

   (29) [$_{??}$ Innai (***mua'**) ma'bottor]?
   who that gamble
   'Who's gambling?'

3. Both T^0 and C^0 are suppressed along the path of long WH-movement.

   (30) Apa mu-pohara (***mua'**) na-uangan iAli (***mua'**) **na**-uma iMina?
   what 2ERG–hope that 3ERG-say NAME that 3ERG-plant NAME
   'What do you hope (*that) was said by Ali to be planted by Mina?'

4. WH-movement blocks the insertion of CP-level adjuncts along its path.

   (31) a. [$_{CP}$ **Bara'** [$_{TP}$ manao ai pa'mai'na]].
   hopefully painful 3ABS his heart
   'Hopefully he'll get his due.'
   b. U-eppei i to [$_{??}$ (***bara'**) na-pole ___].
   1ERG-await 3ABS the people hopefully will-come
   'I'm waiting for the people who are (*hopefully) going to show up.'

5. WH-movement forces a "jailbreak" for second-position clitics.

   (32) a. U-sanga [$_{CP}$ na-mindai' **bo** i de' nomor lima e] .
   1ERG-think will-appear again 3ABS this number five here
   'I think this five will come up again.'
   b. Inna **bo** [$_{??}$ mu-sanga [$_{??}$ na-mindai' ___ ___]]?
   which again 2ERG-think will-appear
   'Which do you think will come up again?'

Intuition: the absence of overt X^0s means the absence of XPs (no C^0 → no CP; Doherty 1993)

Result: the clauses that launch WH-movement are smaller than those which do not.

3.2: Height and Relativized Locality

These results allow us to approach two questions that surround WH-movement:

- STOPPING POINT: what's the position that WH-movement passes through?
- MAXIMAL SIZE: what's the highest projection in a clause that's extracted from?

Background: the clause is organized into a sequence of functional projections.

(33)

C^0	>	T^0	>	POL^0	>	PERF^0	>	PROG^0	>	*voice*^{0}	>	*v*^{0}	>	V^0
that		you would		not		have		been		being		persuaded		

Observation: the Mandar clauses that launch WH-movement contain everything below T^0.

- These clauses can host negation, which sits immediately beneath T^0, in POL^0.
- They contain all of the functional structure beneath that point: PERF^0, *voice*^{0}, *v*^{0}, V^0.

(34) **Innai** [$_{\text{PolP}}$ ndang [$_{\text{PerfP}}$ rua [$_{\textit{voiceP}}$ millamba]]].
who not have leave
'Who has never left?'

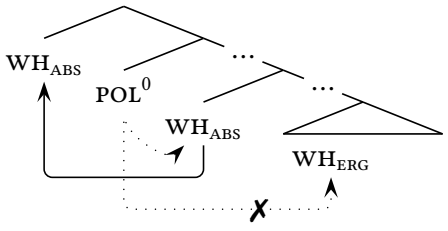
Proposal: Mandar WH-movement proceeds out of PolP, passing through SPEC,POLP.

- The features that drive WH-movement originate at the base of the extended projection (V^0).
- As the extended projection unfolds, the lowest X^0 in which they can be active is POL^0.
- From this position, they trigger AGREE and then MERGE, yielding movement.

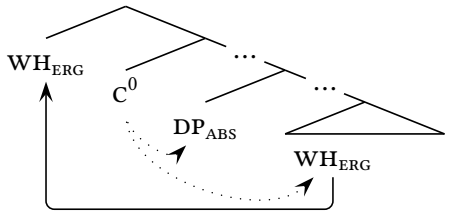
The locality constraint arises as a direct consequence of this low landing site:

- The steps of movement that are triggered low in the extended projection obey strict locality.
- It is only higher up, at the CP-level, that looser locality constraints emerge.

(35) *Low Movement: Strict Locality*



(36) *High Movement: Flexibility*



Sidenote: structure-building stops at PolP in Mandar clauses that launch WH-movement.

- This is a stipulation at present, but it's connected to a broader cross-linguistic pattern.

(37) a. I'm sure [$_{\text{CP}}$ that everyone is coming to Santa Cruz].
b. Who are you sure [$_{\text{TP}}$ ___ is coming to Santa Cruz]?
c. Who are you sure *[$_{\text{CP}}$ that ___ is coming to Santa Cruz]?

3.3: Low Extraction Beyond Mandar

This analysis allows us to capture strictly-local Ā-extraction in a streamlined and elegant way.

- There's no need to postulate a primitive split between A- and Ā-movements (or features)
- There's no need to posit an A=Ā conspiracy in Mandar or other High-Abs languages.
- Rather: the basic restriction follows from two basic components:

  1. The locality profile of movement follows from the height of its landing site, and
  2. The relevant steps of WH-movement target relatively low positions.

The first component is completely necessary; because the Mandar pattern is the norm.

Example One: Reduced Relativization

- English has a type of reduced relative clause that can't contain agreement, T^0, or C^0.

  (38) The headway [$_{??}$ ___ being made on the A-Ā divide]

  (39) a. *The child [$_{TP}$ **doing** watch TV]
  b. *The child [$_{CP}$ that **being** watched]

- This structure is the same size as the clauses that launch WH-movement in Mandar:

  (40) The bananas [$_{PolP}$ **not already** eaten]

  (41) Any students [$_{PerfP}$ **having already** finished the exam]

- And it shows the same constraint on strict locality:

  (42) a. The monkey [$_{PerfP}$ ___ being watched by the children]
  b. *The monkey [$_{PerfP}$ the children watching ___]

Example Two: Romance Pseudorelatives

- Beneath verbs of direct perception, French employs this RC-like structure: Kayne 1982

  (43) J'ai vu Jean **qui** ___ fumait.
  I saw John C was smoking
  'I saw John smoking.'

- The pseudorelative is not a full CP; it can't host topicalization (possible in French RCs),
- And like reduced relatives, it only allows for relativization of the highest argument.

  (44) *J'ai vu Marie **qui** Jean embrassait ___.
  I saw Mary C John was kissing
  BAD: 'I saw Mary being kissed by John.'

Jorge's comment: "it is almost certain that something similar happens in Turkish."

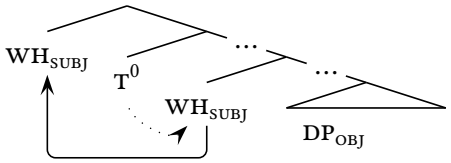
3.4: One Response to Strict Locality

We can see evidence for the second ingredient from the attested responses to the constraint.

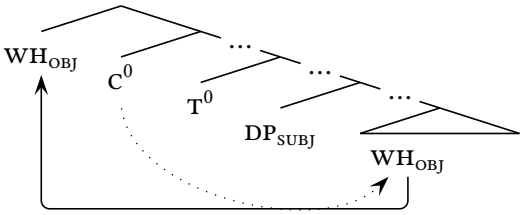
There's one response which is widespread in English: **Reprojection**.

- There are processes of "Ā"-movement associated with low heads, like T^0,
- These processes generally obey strict locality, because they target low landing sites.
- When they violate the strict locality constraint, they appear to target higher positions.
- To avoid strict locality, the movement-driving feature is passed to a higher head, like C^0.

(45) *Local Extraction: Stay Small*



(46) *Non-Local Extraction: Build More*



English WH-movement shows this pattern:

- *Do*-support suggests that non-highest movement targets a higher position.
- Convergent evidence: the possibility for an overt C^0 in Belfast English Henry 1995

(47) a. [$_{TP}$ who ___ left]?
b. [$_{CP}$ what did [$_{TP}$ you buy ___]?

(48) a. I wonder [$_{CP}$ **which dish that** they picked ___].
b. *I wonder [$_{TP}$ **which author that** ___ wrote this book].

So does infinitival relativization:

- Subject and "high adjunct" relatives can receive a pure future interpretation,
- But Object and "low adjunct" relatives require something like an extra covert modal:

(49) a. the guy [$_{TP}$ ___ to fix the sink] is here.
b. the reason [$_{TP}$ ___ to do this] is that it'll save time.

(50) a. the sink [$_{MODP}$ MODAL [$_{TP}$ to fix ___] is this one.
b. the time [$_{MODP}$ MODAL [$_{TP}$ to do it ___] is now.

See also: German/Dutch v2 (per Travis 1984; Zwart 1993)

(51) a. [$_{TP}$ Es hat das Brot gegessen].
it has the bread eaten
'It ate the bread."
b. [$_{CP}$ Das Brot/*es hat [$_{TP}$ das Kind gegessen].
the bread/it has the kid eaten
'The kid ate the bread/*it.' German; **?**

3.5: A Second Response to Strict Locality

The effect that underlies the resolution to strict locality in Mandar is one of **Suspension**.

- There are cases where higher heads stop lower heads from attracting things.

(52) a. He shouldn't've been told, and **nor** [$_{TP}$ ___ should've been [$_{VP}$ anyone else]].

b. J'exige [$_{CP}$ **que** [$_{TP}$ ___ soit be$_{SUBJUNCTIVE}$ éliminée eliminated [$_{VP}$ cette solution]]].
I require that this solution
'I require that this solution be eliminated.'

- There are cases where this effect is correlated with the movement of something else.

(53) a. This proposal was much more problematic
[$_{CP}$ **than** [$_{TP}$ ___ had been [$_{VP}$ any of the ones before it]].

b. [$_{CP}$ **Quand** [$_{TP}$ ___ deviendra when will become [$_{VP}$ ___ célèbre famous ce comédien this comedian]]]?
'When will this comedian become famous?'

- **This effect is visibly called up to resolve problems of locality in Mandar.**
  - In the ditransitive construction, the recipient usually moves to the absolutive position.
    - It triggers a form of agreement which appears in second-position, and
    - It shows the standard binding behavior for absolutive arguments.

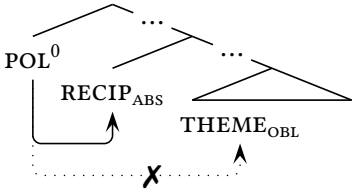
(54) [$_{TP}$ Byasa **o** melo' [$_{VP}$ na-bengan sicco']].
usually 2ABS will 3ERG-give a little
"He will usually give you a little."

  - WH-movement can target the theme in the ditransitive, **but when this occurs**, recipient agreement appears lower and the recipient does not leave the VP.

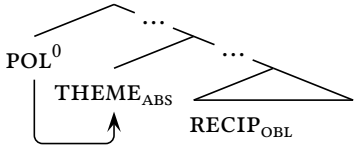
(55) [$_{FP}$ Apa byasa melo' [$_{VP}$ na-bengan **o**]] .
what usually will 3ERG-give 2ABS
"What will he usually give you?"

- Claim: POL^0 wants to attract the theme, so it stops *voice*^{0} from pulling up the recipient.

(56) *Default: No Extracting Theme*



(57) *Solution: Keep the Recipient Low*



4.0: Conclusion

This theory leads us to a new understanding of the Ergative Extraction Constraint.

- There's no need to postulate any mechanism that's specific to ergativity at all.
- The operative constraints are ones that hold in cross-linguistic perspective.

This result fits very naturally with our initial desiderata:

- EXPLANATION: the analysis derives its result from architectural principles of syntax
- EXTENSION: the analysis offers a plausible perspective on patterns beyond Mandar.
- FLEXIBILITY: the analysis provides enough flexibility to account for known variation.

In the same vein, it lays the groundwork to reformulate the A-Ā distinction.

- It allows us to understand the particular properties of "low" Ā-operations:
  - There's no featural difference between strictly-local Ā-movements and non-local ones.
  - The differences in locality emerge exclusively from the height of the landing site.
- And it opens up a path to understanding the other correlates of the split in a new way.

Finally, it opens up a set of questions on the nature of structure-building itself.

- The analysis makes three claims about Extended Projection:
  1. The features which drive movement can be passed along the extended projection.
  2. Features of one x^0 in the extended projection can interfere with features on another.
  3. Movement operations can suspend the need for further structure-building.
- These ideas connect to a range of foundational puzzles in syntactic theory:
  - Extraction-Raising interactions: High WH-movement blocks raising of the subject.

    (58) [$_{CP}$ **Quand** [$_{TP}$ deviendra [$_{VP}$ célèbre **ce comédien**]]]?
    when will.become famous this comedian?

  - The Comp-Trace Effect: Low WH-movement blocks the projection of c^0.

    (59) a. I'm sure [$_{CP}$ that everyone is coming to Santa Cruz].
    b. Who are you sure [$_{TP}$ ___ is coming to Santa Cruz]?
    c. Who are you sure *[$_{CP}$ that ___ is coming to Santa Cruz]?

Finally, this project continues a long tradition of syntactic research at UC Santa Cruz,

- Which engages in a careful and long-term fashion with lesser-studied languages
- And brings its results to bear on the most fundamental questions in syntactic theory.